

UNITED NATIONS
CORRESPONDENTS
ASSOCIATION



PHOTOGRAPHY

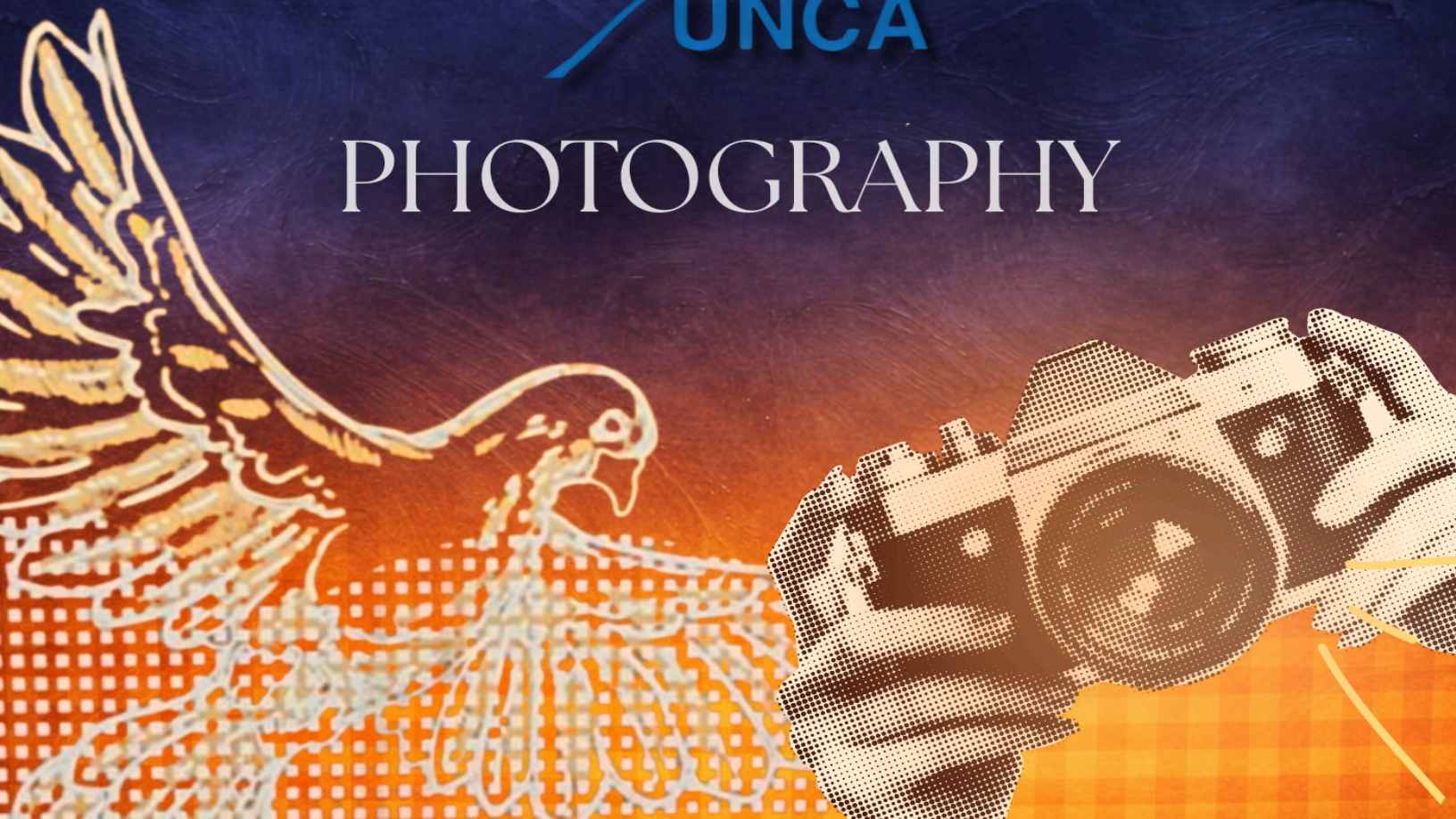


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Letter From the Head of Photography



Greetings, delegates!

It is my honour to announce that I will be serving as the Head of Photography for this year's SMUN. This committee represents more than just a gathering of young minds with cameras; it is a dynamic space where art and creativity meet purpose. Delegates will not only capture photographs, but they will also grow as artists, learn to collaborate under pressure, and push themselves to their limits in the face of challenges.

My journey began as a Logistical Member of the committee, where I witnessed the intricacies of the Model United Nations for the first time. From there, I transitioned into my role as a delegate, which had its fair share of challenges, but amidst the high expectations and pressure to perform, I discovered that your photograph did not have to be perfect; it had to represent a story. A fleeting moment, conveying a thousand emotions in a split second- that might otherwise be overlooked. The true essence

of this experience is to capture the unspoken words written all over a delegate's face and to catch the flicker of hesitation before a breakthrough.

The choices you make, the voice you find, and the story you choose to tell matter more than you may ever realise. For every delegate stepping into this arena, there will be challenges, but how you embrace those challenges is what shapes your journey. You will not be able to change opinions if you take a photograph of an orange or a tree, but if you capture it in a way that catches the voice it silently echoes, in a way that speaks to its growth, its struggle, and its resilience, you can shift perspectives.

Until we meet!

Yours sincerely

Uma Aiyar Walia

Head of Photography

Letter From the Head of Photography

When words become unclear, I shall focus with photographs. When images become inadequate, I shall be content with silence.

– Ansel Adams



Greetings, delegates!

I am Shreya Singh, and I am honoured to be serving as the Head of Photography for the United Nations Correspondents' Association at this year's Sanskriti Model United Nations.

I like to think that photography is in my blood. Ever since I was a kid, fighting over my father's DSLR camera with my sister, I knew that photography was my passion. My father taught me the ropes at a young age and encouraged me to explore nature through my camera. And so, my lens became my voice. For a shy kid such as myself, photography became a quiet escape from the incessant noise of the world.

I stumbled upon this committee through my sister. Watching her as a delegate inspired me to apply for the committee as well, and I haven't left since. This committee, which I now proudly call my own, shaped me into the person I am today. It honed my skills in the sphere of photography, fostered creative thinking, and moulded me into a more confident version of myself.

During the course of this conference, I hope each one of you will break the barriers of creativity, blending together perfect composition with witty and political captions. I hope that you all leave with a different perspective of photography, as an art form that silently speaks volumes and acts as a platform of political transparency.

Lastly, I hope that this committee proves to be an enjoyable experience for all, and I look forward to creating lasting memories with all of you, one frame at a time.

Best of luck, delegates!

Shreya Singh

Head of Photography

Letter From the Additional Director of Photography



Greetings Delegates!

I am Amyra Solomon, and it is an honour for me to serve as the Additional Director of UNCA-Photography at this year's Sanskriti Model United Nations.

Photography has always been a comforting zone for me. There is a sense of happiness that exists when you not only witness an experience, but also capture it through your lens.

My experience in Model United Nations began as a delegate in the DISEC committee. Although the committee was great, it never felt like I was where I was meant to be. It was not until the eighth grade that I joined the UNCA-P, and everything changed. It is here that the elements of creativity, self-expression, and meaning came together and eventually found me a home. This committee has truly made my school years much more meaningful and enjoyable; it's where I've met some of my close friends, and it's increased my love of photography to also pursue it professionally.

The aim of UNCA-P is not just to click photographs, but rather to tell a message, peel the layers of political bias, and uncover the truth. As a committee, we urge all of you to take excellent photographs that tell their own story, whilst giving them a voice through a caption. We hope that this conference will inspire all of you to improve your skills, trust your instincts, and deliver the best photographs.

At the same time, don't forget to create new memories, with new faces- not only in the lens but in real life too!

Best of luck,

Amyra Solomon

Additional Director

UNCA-Photography

Introduction to the UNCA

Established in 1948, the United Nations Correspondents Association represents the UN press corps regarding media access and news coverage issues. It comprises over 200 correspondents and producers from over a dozen nations, including scores of member states, publications, news agencies, and broadcasters. As a representative organisation, it strives to uphold journalistic ideals and protect the rights and privileges of the press.

The relationship between the UNCA and the Secretary-General is based on an agreement signed on 16th November 1995 and included in the UNCA constitution, which unites correspondents, diplomatic delegation members, Secretariat officials, other distinguished personalities, and the Department of Public Information. The UNCA draws its authority from its constitution, which stipulates a mandate and a clear code of conduct. This document represents the organisation's ideals and clarifies the several categories of membership and their

tenures. The body is constituted of regular, associate, honorary, and alumni members. An Executive Committee governs it, wherein the officers of the Association include a President, First, Second, and Third Vice Presidents, a Secretary, a Treasurer, and nine members-at-large.

Under the Dag Hammarskjöld Memorial Scholarship Fund, the UNCA provides recognition to young journalists spread across the globe. They are provided with a stipend to tour the United Nations and report from the General Assembly. The prestigious UNCA Excellence in Journalism Awards are presented every year. The UNCA is recognised each year by the General Assembly in a resolution approved under the auspices of the Committee to Review United Nations Public Information Policies and Activities, also known as The Committee on Information. The United Nations Correspondents Association stated in 2014 after a surge of violence against journalists. The statement stressed the importance of press freedom.

Working of the Committee

At Sanskriti Model United Nations, the United Nations Correspondents Association has crystallised itself as a creative outlet for writers, photographers, and cartoonists. The UNCA separates itself from other committees at SMUN by covering its proceedings and debating issues that are highly relevant to the state of media today. Examples of such issues include the safety of the press and cases of erosion of freedom of speech. It is, but the perfect platform for developing one's incipient talent as a writer, cartoonist, or photographer whilst acknowledging the complications of furnishing the masses with information.

The efforts of the budding delegates from across the three branches- Photography, Journalism, and Cartoonists- will be recognised in the online blog. Based purely on merit, a select few submissions will also be published in the daily newsletter. The newsletter aims to serve as a short-term goal to enhance one's written performance. Evaluating other people's work will also help add another perspective to one's photographs.

Every morning, the delegates are required to convene in their respective venues, where they will be briefed on that day's proceedings, their assignments for that session, and the qualitative and quantitative expectations for each assignment. They will be informed of the deadline for every task. Correspondents **must** meet every deadline, as is the expectation in modern-day press. Delays of any sort won't be looked upon favourably by the Executive Board.

It must be noted that members of the press are not allowed to interfere with committee procedure. They must simply observe it.

Please note that press members are allowed to carry and use electronic devices during the conference. Internet connectivity will, however, only be available in the UNCA room. Usage is only permitted for research purposes. Their usage for anything else is not looked at upon favourably by the Executive Board.

The use of tools such as Chat-GPT or AI humanisers or plagiarism is severely frowned

upon and will lead to immediate disqualification from the award process. Delegates are encouraged to uphold journalistic ethics in every action they take during this conference.

All lobbying must take place on a platform approved and monitored by the Executive Board. Offensive language is highly prohibited and will lead to a direct disqualification from the awards process. All members of the Executive Board must be added to all WhatsApp groups created with the intention of lobbying.

PART A

COMMON GUIDELINES

How to go about Research

At the very basis of journalism lies the inveterate duty of journalists to report news and provide people with thoroughly well-researched information which is factually correct, as well as plausible to the utmost good faith. These factors are not the only ones that an article should comprise. An article must not only be well-written but should also cover both sides of the story and uncover iniquity in the journalist's pursuit of verity. To carry out this objective in the most scrupulous way possible, one must be thoroughly well acquainted with the news agency to which they have been assigned.

Here are a few pointers to keep in mind while going about your research as a member of the press of the United Nations Correspondents Association:

News Agency

A news agency is the portfolio allotted to each journalist in the UNCA. It is, in essence, the better part of one's identity as a journalist. One must be thorough with the research of their allotted news agencies, which should include

their history, establishment, current status, accolades, etc.

Agency Bias

Every journalist is allotted a news agency, which becomes their portfolio for the rest of the conference. When discussing the political spectrum, we're looking at the range of political opinions, from left to right (the required information about the political spectrum is given on page 16). For example, left-leaning agencies often support progressive ideas like government involvement in healthcare or climate action. A well-known example of a left-leaning agency is The Wire. On the other hand, right-leaning agencies tend to support more traditional views, like limited government and free-market policies. Fox News is a good example of a right-leaning agency. Journalists are obligated to adopt the bias of their news agency throughout reporting and committee sessions, which depends on several factors such as ownership, political affiliations, and the country in which their news agency is based. Delegates are required to exhibit their understanding of their news

agency's bias in committee through article submissions **as well as the arguments put forth by them** during crisis discussions. Admitting one's bias goes against the ethics of journalism, no news agency can ever own up to being prejudiced, which provides news agencies a nuance most other portfolios lack.

Reading papers and visiting websites of the news agencies can help you to be exceedingly thorough with the agency's perspective.

Background Guides

Delegates must familiarise themselves thoroughly with the background guide of the

committee assigned to them. Background guides serve as the foundation for the committee's agenda, and as the terminus a quo for the research a journalist is required to undertake. It is recommended that all journalists visit websites to learn more about the agenda and to acquire information for captions. It is also highly suggested that every point that is presented is meticulously verified and fact-checked.

It is recommended that delegates study international relations and world politics in order to be ready for any crisis. They may also review the matrix of the committees in order to gain a better understanding of their procedures.

The Political Spectrum

While researching one's agency bias, a journalist will ineluctably come across certain labels or terms that define the agency's position on the 'left-right' political spectrum. Owing to their ambiguous nature and the fluidity in their meaning, these terms can often be misconstrued and adversely affect how a journalist perceives their agency's bias. This section of the background guide shall thus delve into the intricacies of various positions on the political spectrum a person might find themselves aligning with. The political terms 'left-wing' and 'right-wing' took birth in the French Revolution of 1789. The left, in this political scenario, referred to the revolutionaries who called for the abolition of the monarchy, while the right was constituted by monarchical loyalists. The terms left and right were not employed to name differing political ideologies, per se, but rather to seat proponents and opponents of the issue in a particular manner. However, today, the left and the right are distinguished by ideals that support change and uprising, and the urge to stick to the status quo, respectively.

The Left

In politics, the left refers to an umbrella of egalitarian ideologies and views purporting state control of major institutions of socio-economic life. Leftists tend to regard social welfare as the *raison d'être* of government. Left-wing politics traditionally preach a detachment from religion and support more liberal ideologies. The ideology of liberalism considers protecting and strengthening the freedom of an individual as the central matter in question. Socialism is an example of a standard left-wing ideology practised; communism, however, remains a more radical approach to leftist politics.

The Centre-Left

The centre-left refers to political ideologies and institutions that find a place on the left side of the political spectrum but inch closer to the centre than the left. Also known as the moderate left, it emphasises that the attainment of equality requires personal responsibility on the part of the individual through their abilities and talents. Centre-left ideologies generally support a mixed economy,

a system of social security, government regulation of private enterprises, etc.

The Centre

Centrism is typically a political worldview that involves accommodation and an optimum balance of social equality and social hierarchy. Centrists typically avoid ideologies that would categorise them as either leftist or rightist. A news agency with a centrist 'bias' would typically be neutral to all opinions on an issue.

The Centre-Right

Refers to political ideologies and institutions that find a place on the right side of the political spectrum but inch closer to the centre than the right. Economic liberalism has influenced the economic components of the current centre-right, which generally supports free markets and limited government spending. The moderate right is neither universally

socially conservative nor culturally liberal, and it frequently blends both viewpoints with support for civil liberties and traditional values.

The Right

It refers to the part of the political spectrum where institutions are in favour of free enterprise and private ownership and further tend to support socially traditional hierarchies, ideas, and nationalist beliefs. The ideology of nationalism believes in the unification of the state and the nation, in which case loyalty and devotion to the nation reign supreme. Right-wing politics is defined by a belief that particular social systems and hierarchies are inevitable, natural, normal, or desirable, with natural law, economics, or tradition frequently backing this perspective. In market economies, hierarchy and inequality may be considered as an inevitable outcome of traditional social distinctions or competitiveness. Right-wing politics is seen as the polar opposite of left-wing politics.

PART B

PHOTOGRAPHERS

Introduction to Photography

Photography allows people to capture moments in their own unique manner and tell stories without speaking. The photographers learn how to express themselves through their photographs. During SMUN, the delegates will delve into the art of photography, leaving with a wealth of knowledge and a highly rewarding experience.

When a delegate picks up a camera, they create a new channel for self-expression. As members of the United Nations Correspondents Association, photographers cover the

conference with their cameras and learn how to capture the loud as well as the unnoticed moments in committee sessions and elucidate them with captions that offer insights into the committee's dynamics and the photographer's thought process.

A mere press of the button motivates delegates to learn and aspire to become better artists. Through this committee, our goal is to assist delegates in presenting an open and candid perspective. This will teach delegates how to look for small moments and capture emotion.

Importance of Photography

Photographers have a paramount role in both the global context and within the Model United Nations. They document all the pivotal moments of the conference through their camera lenses and capture important moments that may go unnoticed. Photographers capture emotion and weave stories out of it. Throughout the conference, photography delegates move from committee to committee to capture these significant moments. This not only provides them with opportunities to be able to see how the committees operate, but also allows them to show how a delegate sees the committee.

Delegates will have the opportunity to try out new techniques and experiment with styles.

Photography at SMUN challenges delegates to step outside their comfort zones and stay sharp. Over the course of three days, there will be crisis scenarios, joint tasks alongside journalists and cartoonists, and many more exciting events that give delegates the chance to make friendships and create memories that last long after the conference. Delegates are encouraged to think creatively and truly learn how to convey what they see. They will be assigned various tasks that need quick thinking and the application of all their abilities. Photography will give delegates the chance to not only hone their skills and take excellent photographs but also give them the chance to preserve unforgettable moments that actually define the experience.

Rules of Procedure

In UNCA–Photography, Rules of Procedure regulate task execution, crisis conduct, submissions, movement, and delegate behaviour rather than formal debate. **Rules of Procedure must be followed throughout the conference. Failure to follow them will result in downmarking.**

Points

1. Point of Personal Privilege

This point is used when a delegate experiences any personal discomfort or inconvenience that hinders their ability to participate in the committee.

For example, this point can be used if the delegate wants the Executive board or a fellow delegate to repeat anything.

2. Point of Parliamentary Inquiry

This point is used when a delegate needs clarification or has a question about committee procedure.

For example, this point can be used if a delegate requires clarification regarding the given task.

and coordinate amongst one another without formal moderation. It can be used during a verbal crisis. The maximum time an unmoderated caucus can be raised for is 20 minutes.

How to raise the motion: “The delegate of The Hindu would like to raise a motion for an unmoderated caucus for a total time of 15 minutes.”

2. Motion for Extension:

This motion is used to extend an unmoderated caucus. It must be maintained that they can only be extended by half of the original time they were raised for.

For instance, if an unmoderated caucus was originally raised for 10 minutes, then for an extension, the motion would be raised by stating: “The delegate of the Agence France Press would like to raise a motion to extend the unmoderated caucus by a total of 5 minutes.”

Motions

1. Motion for an Unmoderated Caucus

During an Unmoderated Caucus, delegates are allowed to freely interact

Proceedings

Tasks

Each session will hold a unique essence through tasks. In every session, delegates will be provided with a different task to accomplish. This is an excellent way to improve your photography skills, as it encourages quick thinking and challenges you to think creatively.

Crisis

The crisis presented to the delegates will offer a new perspective on photography, allowing them to demonstrate their skills in high-pressure situations with a time limit and more restrictions than in a normal task. One conference, one crisis.

Captions

Captions act as a medium for delegates to express themselves, report on the conference through pictures, and share their opinions on the situation at hand using words. The

delegates will have to provide a caption (the length of which will vary per task) for each picture they click to give an insight into their thought process. The captions will also reflect the level of focus of delegates during committee proceedings. It is expected of delegates to be able to express their opinions on the committee and its deliberations.

Collaboration

To increase teamwork and allow photographers to learn about the proceedings in journalism, a collaborative video task will be created. Along with this, photographers will be capturing the press conference, which is an essential part of UNCA as well as SMUN.

Discipline

Photographers must not disturb any delegates while observing committees and photographing them.

Important Submission Guidelines

No delegate is allowed to disrupt the committee at any moment concerning posing for pictures or any such related topics. If any such incident is reported, the delegate will be barred from the award process.

Punctuality

A high level of punctuality is required from all photography delegates in UNCA. Although it is a basic discipline, it is extremely important. Each photographer is expected to adhere to the given deadlines for tasks and submissions. Delays in submissions will be duly noted and will lead to negative marking.

Originality

There is a zero-tolerance policy for plagiarism in this committee. All pieces presented by photographers must be their own, clicked during the days of the conference itself. The idea/inspiration behind the photographs must also be original, and students are encouraged to think creatively and outside the box during all events. Captions must not be

plagiarized. **Usage of AI in any capacity is strictly prohibited,** and the delegate will be heavily downmarked for the same.

Editing

Only basic editing of photographs is permitted for all events, unless the Executive Board specifies otherwise. Excessive editing, as well as the use of filters and presets, is highly discouraged. Minimal editing is encouraged.

Procedure

Submissions are to be made only on the Google Drive; **no submissions sent via email will be accepted.** The photographers must adhere to the following procedure: Camera -> Laptops -> Google Drive -> Day Folder -> Session folder -> Task folder -> News agency folder -> Google Doc -> Photographs+Captions.

NOTE: Photographers must use a camera only; phones/tablets will not be permitted for taking photographs.

Samples

Note: These samples are provided solely for reference. Any form of imitation or replication will be considered plagiarism and will result in downmarking.

Type 1: Agency and Country-specific captions

Task: Forced Mistake

Agency: MENA (Middle East News Agency, Country- Egypt)



Caption: This picture beautifully captures the concept of forced mistake, even when all the surroundings are blurry and unclear. The placard of a delegate stands out, showing the power of a voice and the importance of every single action that is taken. *Islamic Republic of Pakistan demonstrates the qualities of unity and authority that are similar to those of Egyptian government.*

(EB Note: The caption displays the agency's bias masterfully, including the delegate of a country that maintains good relations with Egypt.)

Task: Delegate Bonding

Agency: MENA (Middle Eastern News Agency, Country- Egypt)

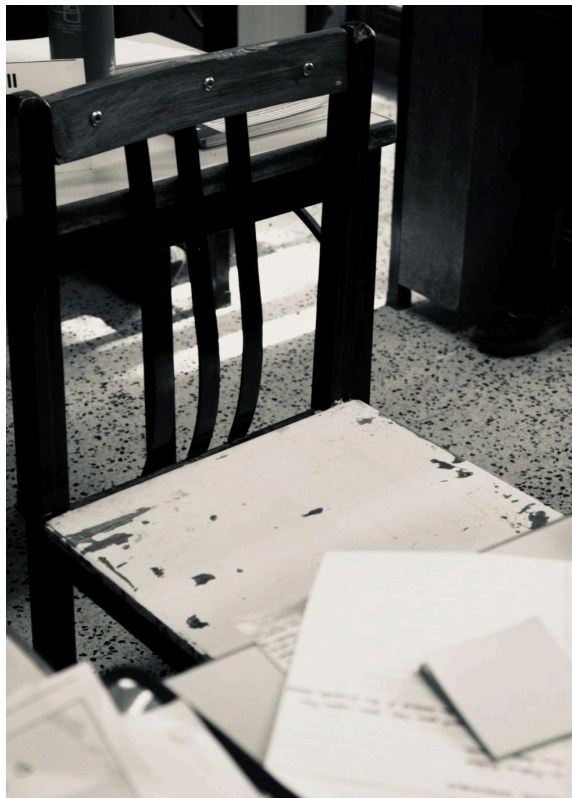


Caption: *The above picture captures two of the most important qualities of the Egyptian government, which are unity and fraternity.* The fist bump holds great importance, showcasing how friends and alliances can be made anywhere, anyhow, and anytime in any situation.

(EB Note: The delegate puts the spotlight on the core values of the country to which their news agency belongs)

Task: Proof of allegiance

Agency: WAFA (Country- The State of Palestine)



A seat of power but a *void of humanity*. (In the theme Proof of Allegiance, *this emptiness represents how Israel abandons humanity and empathy, but Palestine still occupies the seat of defiance.*)

(**EB Note:** In this caption, the delegate sheds light on the crimes committed by the State of Israel against its own citizens and uses the empty chair as a powerful metaphor for Palestine's defiance, despite not being recognised as a state by many nations.)

Type 2: Committee Observation Captions

Task: Depict the rivalry between 2 delegates

Agency: Times of India (Country- India)

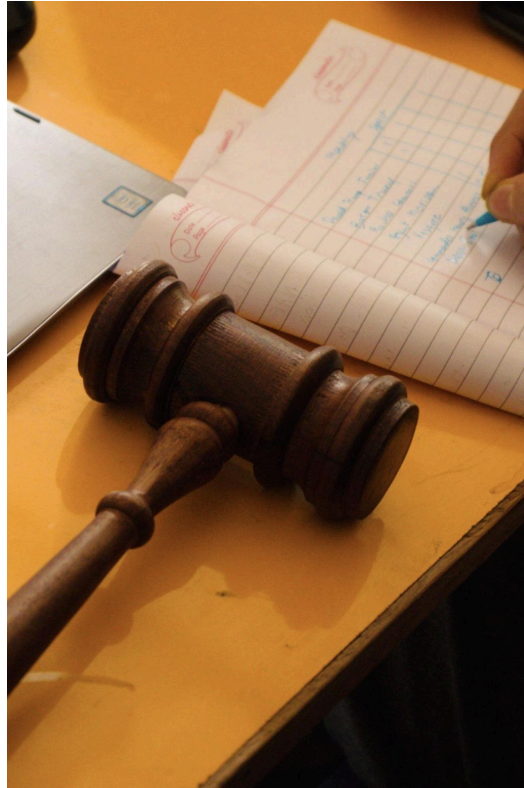


Caption: *Santosh Gangwar and Lalu Prasad Yadav, both from the BJP, having an intra-party argument caused by a hateful chit sent by VP Singh. Gangwar dominated Yadav, showcasing superior political planning.*

(**EB Note:** The caption shows situational awareness of the delegate during the committee session, not only describing the proceedings but also hinting at the power dynamics at play within the party.)

Task: Capturing the essence of an MUN

Agency: WAFA (Country- State of Palestine)



Caption: THE GAVEL

The most powerful element of a committee – as the gavel strikes, heated debates in the committee are concluded, decisions are finalized, and the order is restored. Delegates have to move forward and turn the discussions into resolutions and reforms.

(EB note: This caption focuses on explaining how the subject of the picture- a gavel- plays an important role in MUN.)

Type 3: Interpretative Photography

Task: Metaphorical Photography

Agency: WAFA (Country- State of Palestine)



Caption: "A clock nearing midnight."

As the hands of the clock move closer to midnight, the sense of urgency and threat deepens. In the Doomsday Accords Committee, delegates discuss the sense of urgency and the irreversible conflict following threats of climate change. General Michael

"Ironclad" Reyes and Donald Trump Junior deliver speeches, helping L.U.N.AR gain two members and assert its dominance, ultimately pushing S.O.L.AR into the shadows as the second most powerful cabinet. As the clock ticks, the countdown to irreversible change begins.

Type 4: Editing Tasks

Task: The Colour of Emotions

Agency: BBC News (Country- United Kingdom)



Caption: *Anger*

In this *fierce, emotion-filled speech*, Henry L. Stimson, the Secretary of War, is speaking about the assassination of his wife on live television. In this intense moment of vulnerability, some question his authority in these times of stress.

Type 5: Photo Mosaic

Agency: Hindustan Times (Country- India)



Caption: With the torch made out of flowers, some of the leaves made out of saree designs, the map made out of the indian ocean, the eye-pleasing SMUN logo signifies the unity found in India's, Sanskriti school's Inter-school MUN, with over 15 school delegations from all over India joining in.